

Essential Linux Commands for Cloud Beginners

Mastering basic Linux commands is the single most important skill for anyone starting a career in Cloud and DevOps. These everyday tools help you inspect servers, debug crashes, and manage applications without relying on a graphical interface.

What you'll learn:

- 1 Checking Server Disk Space
- 2 Monitoring Live Application Logs
- 3 Finding and Stopping Stuck Processes
- 4 Checking Network Ports and Connections

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Checking Server Disk Space

Servers run out of disk space all the time, causing databases and web apps to crash unexpectedly. The 'df' command shows your file systems, and the '-h' flag makes the numbers human-readable (like gigabytes instead of raw bytes). It is the very first check you should run when investigating a mysteriously broken application.

```
$df -h
```

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Monitoring Live Application Logs

When troubleshooting, you rarely want to read an entire million-line log file from top to bottom. The 'tail' command shows the end of a file, and the '-f' flag stands for 'follow', meaning it streams new log lines directly to your screen in real time as your application generates them.

```
$tail -f /var/log/syslog
```

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Finding and Stopping Stuck Processes

Sometimes applications hang and refuse to shut down normally, blocking your ports and eating up CPU. You use 'ps aux' to list every running process, pipe it into 'grep' to filter for your specific app name, and then use 'kill -9' followed by the process ID to force-stop it.

```
$ps aux | grep node  
kill -9 <Process_ID>
```

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Checking Network Ports and Connections

Deploying an app often fails because another service is already using the exact same network port. The 'netstat' command lets you inspect all active network sockets and listening ports so you can verify your web server or database is running where it is supposed to be.

```
$netstat -tuln
```


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Key Takeaways

- + Always use the '-h' flag with commands like df and du for readable sizes.
- + Use tab-completion to auto-fill long file names and prevent typos.
- + Keep a personal cheat sheet of commands you use frequently.
- + Test destructive commands safely in a temporary cloud instance first.
- + Read the manual page (using 'man command_name') if you forget flags.

Watch Out For

- ! Running 'rm -rf' without double-checking your current directory path.
- ! Using 'kill -9' as a first resort instead of a graceful shutdown.
- ! Blindly copy-pasting complex multi-line bash scripts from untrusted websites.

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